



Cadillac Utilities Department
WATER RESOURCES
DIVISION

FEB 29 2016

CADILLAC DISTRICT OFFICE

February 26, 2016

Mr. Jamie Wade, P.E.
Michigan Department of Environmental Quality
Cadillac District Office
120 West Chapin Street
Cadillac, Michigan 49601

Re: Violation Notice – Cadillac WWTP VN No. VN-006346

Dear Mr. Wade,

This is in response to your letter dated February 1, 2016 which you informed us of violations that occurred at the Cadillac waste water treatment plant. We will describe what happened and what was done to mitigate the situation. I believe that there were two separate incidents that took place leading up to the violations noted. The first period of violation took place from October 21, 2014 to November 27, 2014 and the second violation period was from January 9, 2015 to June 23, 2015.

At this time it isn't entirely clear what the influent or operational problems were because the plant supervisor that was in charge during the duration of violation periods is no longer here. I do know that there was an influx of material in both instances that caused a large mass of floating sludge on the primary clarifiers. This floating mass caused severe settling issues within the plant. The solids passing through the aeration basins into the secondary clarifiers' caused bulking within the clarifier tanks. The operators were instructed to continually increase the RAS and WAS, which increased the solids loading problem on the plant. The bulking made its way through the tertiary treatment causing our clothe filtration to bypass. The solids then made it through U.V. disinfection reducing U.V. dose and then into the river. I believe that a lack of communication and supervision led to the majority of these problems.

The increased unsettled solids passing through the plant caused the following violations on several occasions between October 21, 2014 and November 27, 2014:

- Total Suspended Solids 7-day Ave. mg/L

- Total Suspended Solids 7-day Ave. lbs./day
- CBOD5 lbs./day
- CBOD5 mg/L
- Fecal Coliform Max 7-day Gm.
- Ammonia as (N) mg/L
- Ammonia as (N) 7-day Ave. lbs./day
- Ammonia lbs./day
- Total Phosphorus

The following operational procedures were put into action to mitigate the issues dated above:

- Double pumping to reduce the solids in the primary clarifiers.
- Increased ferric chloride feed to aid in secondary settling.
- Increased aeration to provide more oxygen for the bacteria and to aid in driving off Ammonia.
- Mild Chlorine solution to control filamentous.
- Increased IPP monitoring to minimize the possibility of unwanted inflow.

The increased unsettled solids passing through the plant caused the following violations on several occasions between January 9, 2015 and June 23, 2015:

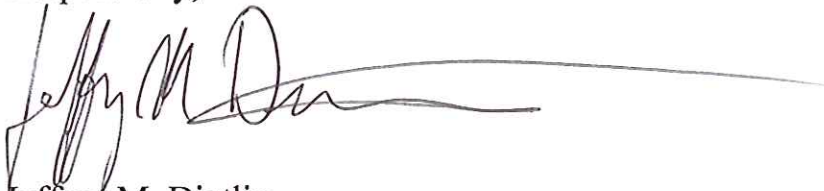
- Total Suspended Solids 7-day Ave. mg/L
- Total Suspended Solids 7-day Ave. lbs./day
- Total Suspended Solids Monthly Ave. Max
- Total Suspended Solids % Removal
- CBOD5 Monthly Ave. Max
- CBOD5 lbs./day
- CBOD5 mg/L
- Fecal Coliform Max 7-day Gm.
- Ammonia as (N) mg/L
- Ammonia as (N) 7-day Ave. lbs./day
- Ammonia Monthly Ave. Max
- pH

The following operational procedures were put into action to mitigate the issues dated above:

- Double pumping to reduce the solids in the primary clarifiers.
- Increased ferric chloride feed to aid in secondary settling.
- Increased aeration to provide more oxygen for the bacteria and to aid in driving off Ammonia.
- Mild Chlorine solution to control filamentous.
- Increased IPP monitoring to minimize the possibility of unwanted inflow.

At this time I would like to thank you for your time addressing the violations that took place. As I previously stated before the supervisor that was here at the time of the violation periods is no longer here. That being said I will never completely know all of the exact causes or events that took place. I also cannot give an explanation as to why the supervisor did not give written notice for each occurrence as is required in our NPDES permit. The only information I have is the vague violation reports I have received from the previous supervisor and information given to me by the operators. The poor communication and lack of supervision have been removed from the operations at the Cadillac waste water treatment plant. Through this I believe we will not have these operational issues again. Again I would like to thank you for your time.

Respectfully,

A handwritten signature in dark ink, appearing to read 'Jeffrey M. Dietlin', with a long horizontal flourish extending to the right.

Jeffrey M. Dietlin
Director of Utilities
City of Cadillac
231-779-7346 direct line
231-775-0906 fax

State of Michigan Department of Environmental Quality

This is to certify that

Jeffrey M. Dietlin

having submitted acceptable evidence of qualifications, in accordance with the requirements of the Rules Governing the Certification of Sewage Treatment Works Operators, is qualified to operate any sewage treatment works of any of the following classifications:

A, B, C, D

Issued

March 4, 2014

Expires

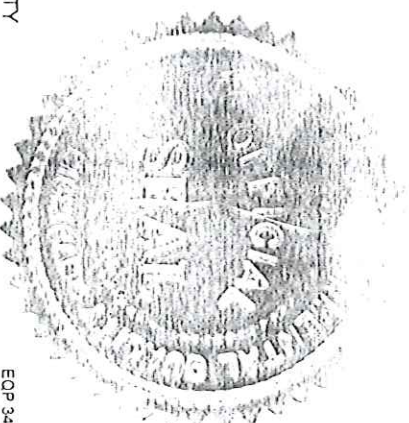
April 15, 2017

Operator I.D. Number

10435

ISSUED BY THE DIRECTOR OF THE DEPARTMENT OF ENVIRONMENTAL QUALITY
UNDER AUTHORITY OF ACT 451 PA 1994 AS AMENDED

EQP 3402
REV 3/2014



DATE: 2-26-2016

TO: Michigan Department of Environmental Quality
Water Resources Division

ATTN: Brian Jankowski, Supervisor
Cadillac District Office

I hereby designate JEFFERY M. DIETRICH as the responsible operator in charge of the waste treatment facilities at CADILLAC W.W.T.P. discharge Permit No. MI0020257. He/she has met the requirements of the Department and has been properly certified. The Certificate No. is 10435, and the license classification(s) are A, B, C, D. The names, certificate number, and license classification(s) of other operators who are employed at the above facilities are listed below.

<u>Name</u>	<u>Certificate No.</u>	<u>License Classification(s)</u>
<u>Doug Langworthy</u>	<u>18398</u>	<u>C, D</u>
<u>Derek Goodrich</u>	<u>18456</u>	<u>C, D</u>
<u>KEVIN Briggs</u>	<u>19127</u>	<u>C, D</u>
<u>BRETT BALCOLM</u>	<u>19178</u>	<u>D</u>
<u>DAVE SKIFF</u>	<u>19190</u>	<u>D</u>

JEFF DIETRICH
Name
UTILITIES DIRECTOR
Title
CITY OF CADILLAC
Company

Send this form to: Brian Jankowski, Supervisor
Water Resources Division
Cadillac District Office
Department of Environmental Quality
120 West Chapin Street
Cadillac, MI 49601